



University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila
2019-2020 Semestre 1
E-Learning unit

English - level 1

– Lesson 7 –

English conjunctions

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Institut	Département	Année	Spécialité
-Lettres et Langues étrangères	- Français	-Français	Licence 1
-Sciences et Techniques	-MI- ST	-MI- ST	Licence 1
-Sciences Economique	-SE	-Toutes les spécialités	Licence 1

Objectives of lesson 7

- i. To make students aware of the existence of different conjunctions
- ii. To familiarize students with different types of conjunctions and use them appropriately according to their meaning and function.

1. Definition:

A **conjunction** is a part of speech that joins words, phrases or clauses together.

There are three types of conjunctions:

1. Coordinating conjunctions

Coordinating conjunctions, also called coordinators, are conjunctions that connect two or more equal items.

- **And:** expresses chronological order and combines two or more positive ideas.
- **But:** expresses opposition between two ideas.
- **Or:** presents a choice between ideas. Only one of the choices is true or possible.
- **Nor:** combines two or more negative ideas. Neither of the ideas is true or possible.
- **Yet:** expresses opposition between ideas (just like "but").
- **For:** explains a reason or purpose.
- **So:** shows an effect or result

Examples:

- He plays tennis **and** soccer
- He works quickly **but** accurately
- You'd better do your homework, **or** you'll get a terrible grade.

2. Correlative conjunctions

Correlative conjunctions are used in pairs. They work in pairs to coordinate two items. Examples of correlative conjunctions include:

- **Both...and:** Connects two positives (this and that).
 - She is beautiful and she is smart. / She is **both** beautiful **and** smart.

- **Neither ... nor:** Connects two negatives (not this not that).
 - She is not tall. She is not short. / She is **neither** tall **nor** short.
- **Either ... or:** One of two.
 - You **either** come with us **or** I will punish you.
- **Not only...but also:** Links two clauses.
 - He disappointed **not only** his father **but also** everybody else around him.

3. Subordinating conjunctions

Subordinating conjunctions, also called subordinators, are conjunctions that join a dependent (or subordinating) clause to an independent (or main) clause.

Examples:

- He reads the newspapers **after** he finishes work.
- **Even if** you get the best grade in the writing test, you'll need to pass an oral test.
- **Although** he is very old, he goes jogging every morning.
- She didn't go to school **because** she was ill.
- They went to bed **since** it was late
- **As soon as** the teacher had arrived, they started work.

Cause	Concession and contrast	Condition	Time
as because in order that since so that	although as as though even though just as though whereas while	even if if in case provided that unless	after as soon as as long as before once still till until when whenever while

Time for practice:

Link the following pairs of sentences with the appropriate linking word:

Even though, for, but, thus, when.

- 1) I should not forget my umbrella. It is raining.
- 2) She did her best in the exam. She failed.
- 3) She stayed up the whole night. She woke up late.
- 4) We did our best to collect money to help him. It was not enough.
- 5) George wanted to travel. His mother fell sick so he stayed with her.

References

- 1) Alexander. L. G. (1990). Longman English Grammar Practice. New york: Longman.
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- 3) Eastwood.J. (1999). Oxford Practice Grammar. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- 4) Murdphy. R. (2012). English Grammar in Use. Cambridge. Cambridge University Press.
- 5) Chalker. S. (1992). A Student's English Grammar. Longman: England.

